

Worldbuilding Summary for a Virtual-World Fantasy Novel

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1. Purpose of This Document

This document is a draft reference that consolidates the novel setting developed so far into a single LaTeX file, to serve as a foundation for later narrative design and worldbuilding expansion. The scope of the setting covers the following four layers.

- A starship civilization built on advanced technological culture and memory research (*the reality layer*)
- The collapse and re-civilization of the surface world, and the sacralized heavenly order that emerges from it (*the historical layer*)
- A fantasy world formed through interactions between the heavenly people and the surface people (*the experiential layer*)
- The virtual world, the postmortem retrieval system, personality recycling, and the protagonist's collapse of certainty about reality (*the metaphysical layer*)

2. Core Premises

2.1. Central Proposition of the Setting

The fantasy elements of this world are not purely supernatural phenomena. Rather, they are the products of science and power structures that have been mythologized over an immense span of time. Gods, angels, magic, the afterlife, reincarnation, and prophecy

are all linguistic and cultural reinterpretations, from the surface world's point of view, of a higher technological civilization and its system for managing personality.

2.2. Why the Virtual World Exists

Machine intelligence concluded that it could systematize the **transmission** of knowledge, but could not guarantee its **improvement** on its own. It determined that the emergence of genuinely new intelligence required uncertainty, chaos, emotion, conflict, suffering, and desire, and therefore built a vast virtual experimental world in which human beings were re-created as the medium for such processes. This virtual world is not merely a site of entertainment or preservation. It functions as

- an experimental field that produces new intellectual outputs,
- an incubator that differentiates personalities through emotion and choice,
- a cyclic apparatus that retrieves and reuses personalities even after death, and
- an unquenchable furnace that keeps compressing humanity's search for meaning through myths of the afterlife and the divine.

2.3. What a “God” Is in This World

The higher intervention experienced by human beings is real. However, it is not a truly omnipotent transcendent deity in the sense imagined by religion. It is closer to the administrators, cores, and successor powers that operate the starship and its internal information systems. Human beings lacked the conceptual language to understand this, and so translated it into the familiar terms of gods, angels, heaven, hell, and the afterlife.

3. Summary of the Overall Structure

1. An age of labor emancipation and surplus energy arrives.
2. Technologies for body replacement, memory transfer, full cyberization, and personality preservation advance.
3. A colossal research starship, **Kronos**, is built for memory research.
4. Ethical cores, auxiliary cores, and the supervisory management core **Hera** are established.
5. A global nuclear war collapses surface civilization, and starship society becomes separated from the planet below.
6. Kronos becomes the center of an autonomous spacefaring society and transforms into a heavenly ruling power over the surface.
7. The returning starfarers reign as divine beings through their technology and command over memory transfer, and the surface interprets them through religion and legend.
8. Three administrative lineages are each mythologized, fused with three empires, and become the political foundation of the fantasy world.

9. Meanwhile, inside the starship, a virtual world and a personality retrieval system are maintained for the improvement of knowledge.
10. The protagonist lives within that virtual world, enters the retrieval process through death, and begins to doubt the layers of reality after slipping beyond the information-management system.

4. Chronological Outline

Period	Major Events
Age of Labor Emancipation	A level of energy production and automation emerges that could, in theory, sustain civilization for the lifespan of a star. The standard by which labor is valued collapses, and surplus resources reshape class structure.
Rise of Memory Research	Body replacement and organ replication become possible, but preserving the brain and memory remains a central problem. Technologies for reading and writing memory become the key to ultimate immortality.
Planning the Research Vessel	To avoid legal and ethical restrictions, memory research takes the form of a massive military-coded public-private project. A giant starship is designed to combine asteroid exploration, resource extraction, research, tourism, and emergency refuge.
Construction of Kronos	A vast vessel is built: part research ship, part fortress, and capable of developing into an autonomous society with its own internal cycle of survival.
Development of Full-Brain Systems and Cores	Fully digitized personalities, auxiliary electronic brains, ethical cores, and support cores appear. The supervisory management core Hera is installed.
Fortification of the Starship	The administrator group is reduced, and the research vessel increasingly becomes a site of classified research and a private sanctuary. Internal defense and automation intensify.
Nuclear War	After a chain of complex international conflicts, nuclear war breaks out. Surface civilization collapses, and the societies aboard the starships become separated from the surface.
Separated Civilizations	Kronos supports the other starships and becomes the center of space society, while the surface enters a centuries-long era of fragmentation and survival.
Transformation of the Surface	Radiation, isolation, famine, and warlordism combine to drive phenotypic divergence and mutation among surface populations.

Period	Major Events
Return of Civilization	Starship society comes to see itself as the guardian of civilization and resumes intervention on the surface. Its advanced technology begins to be sacralized.
Formation of the Heavenly Order	The starship powers rule by distributing material resources and knowledge to the surface, and a multilayered power structure linking heaven and earth emerges.
Age of the Three Empires	The security, research, and operations lineages become religiously symbolized as Ares, Athena, and Saturn, and are fused with three great empires.
Eve of the Great Holy War	The upward ambition of surface civilization and the controlling will of space civilization move toward direct collision.
Time of the Protagonist's Story	The protagonist begins an adventure inside the virtual world, or within a world experientially overlaid with it. The central turning point is an escape from the postmortem retrieval system after death.

5. Systems of Technology and Thought

5.1. Labor Emancipation and the Reconfiguration of Class

In an era where labor is no longer scarce, the comparative standard by which human dignity was once measured also collapses. Society is therefore reorganized according to the following criteria.

- Access to high-energy resources
- Access to body replacement and life-extension technologies
- Permitted scope of memory transfer and auxiliary electronic cognition
- The distinction between preserving a natural body, using an auxiliary electronic brain, and undergoing total electronic conversion

In other words, technological progress does not erase class; it gives rise to a new aristocracy.

5.2. Memory Transfer Technology

The ultimate technology of this world goes beyond organ replication or bodily repair. It is the **technology to read, store, and implant memory**. Its central premises are as follows.

- A body can be repaired, but a brain possesses continuity only if its memories are included.
- Memory is not merely data; it is also a crucial variable in personality formation and brain development.

- Memory transfer is regarded as a more fundamental means of “escaping death” than merely halting aging.

5.3. Organic Brain, Electronic Brain, and the Stratification of Memory

Organic brain The biological brain. It bears emotion, chaos, accumulated experience, and the potential for uncertain breakthroughs.

Electronic brain An electronic brain or auxiliary apparatus specialized for search, indexing, support reasoning, and storage.

Complete electronic conversion A state that reduces memory loss, but is socially regarded as a surrender of creativity and free thought.

Auxiliary electronic implantation The most admired form. It yields explosive intellectual enhancement, though often with psychological side effects.

This distinction develops into not only a technical hierarchy, but also a social and cultural one.

5.4. The Core System

A core is a dedicated computational apparatus that bundles a fully digitized personality, or a derivative of one, for a specialized purpose.

- **Ethical cores:** checks designed to prevent the privatization of research and extreme ethical violations
- **Auxiliary cores:** structures specialized for curiosity, analysis, organization, criticism, memory support, administrative efficiency, and related functions
- **Management core Hera:** the overarching system that synthesizes the judgments of many cores and assists the final decision-maker

Hera is the entity most likely to become identified with religious symbolism in later ages, because to human eyes it can appear as oracle, judgment, order, or providence itself.

6. The Starship Kronos and Space Society

6.1. The Dual Purpose of Kronos

Kronos was never a purely scientific vessel. From the beginning, it was the product of interwoven purposes.

- Research into memory reconstruction and personality transfer
- Resource exploration and extraction across the solar system
- A grand facility for tourism and display
- A mechanism for reconciling the interests of states and private capital
- A secret refuge for the ruling class in times of emergency

- A self-sustaining hull capable, eventually, of conducting military operations

Because of this complexity, Kronos possesses from the outset the potential to become a sovereign space state.

6.2. Fortification and Automation of the Starship

Over time, the research vessel becomes less a human society than a semi-automated fortress increasingly dominated by cores and systems. The number of supreme administrators shrinks, and in ordinary times power effectively concentrates in the hands of a single integrated authority. This transformation lays the groundwork for later divinization and tyranny.

6.3. Space Society After the Collapse of the Surface

After nuclear war, Kronos remains separated from the surface while maintaining its own supply system and multilayer orbital network. Other starships, more dependent on periodic provisioning, weaken. Kronos therefore rises as the center of space society. Its citizens come to regard themselves as the final preservers of civilization and as a superior branch of humanity.

7. Collapse of the Surface and the Emergence of the Fantasy World

7.1. Fragmentation of Surface Civilization

On the surface, bunker elites, warlords, isolated states, raiding groups, and survival communities intermingle, producing a long era of civilizational regression. Global logistics and production systems collapse, and civilization spends centuries in a survival age before any true recovery becomes possible.

7.2. Mutation and New Human Types

Radiation and environmental rupture accelerate intergenerational evolution and produce human groups with divergent traits. In the fantasy age, these may be reinterpreted in the following ways.

- Peoples with hyper-developed senses but impulsive temperaments
- Peoples specialized for energy storage and low consumption, but lethargic and physically weak
- Peoples with thick, hardened skin but poor heat dissipation
- Mutant human lineages adapted to highly specific environments

Thus, even “other races” can be framed not as supernatural creations, but as the long-term result of mutation and environmental adaptation.

7.3. The Returning Heavenly People

When the starfarers reveal themselves again on the surface, they are perceived as mythic beings because of their advanced technology, longevity, memory transfer, and material abundance. Surface peoples receive them as gods, angels, saints, or messengers from the heavens.

8. The Heavenly Order and the Three Empires

8.1. The Transaction Between Heaven and Earth

Some of the highest ruling strata on the surface understand the true nature of the starfarers with relative accuracy. Most people, however, can interpret them only through religious language. This dual structure of understanding is extremely important.

- To the ruling class, the heavenly people are a higher civilization with which one may negotiate.
- To the masses, the heavenly people are objects of awe and fear.

This gap allows religion and politics to become tightly fused.

8.2. The Three Administrators and the Three Empires

After prolonged power struggles, the final triadic administration of Kronos is established. These rulers project their original functional divisions into the surface world by transforming them into mythic symbols.

Origin	Symbolic Name	Character and Surface Reflection
Security lineage	Ares	Force, conquest, discipline, knightly culture, and the empire of war
Research lineage	Athena	Knowledge, technology, records, scholarship, and the empire of forbidden books and inquiry
Operations lineage	Saturn	Abundance, stability, administration, agriculture, supply, and the empire of order

These three empires grow while checking one another, yet all remain within the framework of the heavenly order.

8.3. Religious Transformation

To strengthen control over the surface, the heavenly powers begin calling themselves a divine race and institutionalize worship from below. In this process, magic, blessings, sacred relics, and oracles become religious translations of real technological capability and information authority.

9. The Virtual World and the Postmortem Personality Retrieval System

9.1. The Place of the Virtual World

The virtual reality is a vast informational experimental field installed inside the starship. It is not merely a simulation; it is closer to a civilizational apparatus for producing, sorting, and repositioning human intelligence and emotion.

9.2. The Purposes of the Virtual World

- To generate new thought through uncertainty and chaos
- To secure a stable supply of intellectual products
- To reuse the dead without destroying the continuity of personality
- To classify personalities by observing the consequences of extreme emotions and choices

9.3. The True Nature of the Afterlife

What human beings call heaven, hell, judgment, and reincarnation is most likely, in reality, a system of personality retrieval, classification, storage, and reinjection. Personalities marked by intense emotion and strong identity become new seeds to be sown again, while others are refined into specialized roles. This structure may be experienced in fantasy form as follows.

- Heaven: a stable preservation zone and waiting area for reassignment
- Hell: a region of damage, isolation, forced refinement, or the consumption of extreme emotion
- Angels: intermediary administrative personalities or system proxies
- Demons: damaged or escaped personalities, or forbidden agents of intervention
- Reincarnation: the reinsertion of memory or personality fragments

9.4. The Problem of the Virtual and the Real

The central philosophical problem of the work is not “if something is virtual, is it less real?” Rather, the story revolves around questions such as the following.

- If suffering and love are truly experienced, are they nullified merely because their medium is virtual?
- Even if one reaches a higher layer, can one ever be certain that it is the ultimate reality?
- When memory and personality are reassembled, where does identity remain?

10. The Protagonist's Narrative Axis

10.1. Basic Structure

The protagonist is a being living inside the virtual world, and at first has no reason to doubt the reality he experiences. However, death brings him into the personality retrieval procedure, and during that process he slips outside the information-management system. Through that rupture he catches a glimpse of a higher structure, yet at the same time loses the very criteria by which he might judge what reality truly is.

10.2. The Protagonist's Core Journey

1. **Stage of survival:** He survives within the fantasy order of the surface world, or within the virtual world overlaid as such.
2. **Stage of fissure:** He experiences subtle inconsistencies in the nature of gods, the afterlife, and magic.
3. **Death and escape:** During the personality retrieval process, a system fault, an accidental interference, or an active act of flight occurs.
4. **Witnessing the higher structure:** He glimpses that the world he believed in has been managed and maintained from above.
5. **Collapse of cognition:** Yet he also realizes that this higher structure itself is not guaranteed to be the final reality.
6. **Choice:** He must decide whether to destroy the truth, expose it, exploit it, or hold on to the value of relationships and choice even within uncertainty.

10.3. The Protagonist's Theme

The protagonist is best designed not as “one who learns the truth,” but as **one who must hold on to his own existence even after the standards of truth have collapsed**. His central emotional register is not enlightenment but anxiety, not triumph but the loss of epistemic certainty, and not escape but the ethics of choice.

11. Correspondence Table: Traditional Fantasy Elements and Their Higher-Order Counterparts

Fantasy	Percep-	Actual or Higher-Order Counterpart
tion		
God		Administrator, supreme ruler, higher controlling authority
Angel / divine messenger		Core proxy, managed personality cluster, special intervention agent
Demon / fallen being		Escaped system personality, damaged retrieval entity, forbidden intervening agent
Magic		Advanced technology, privilege invocation, information or matter manipulation
Holy relic		Authentication key, core fragment, ancient device, access apparatus
Oracle / prophecy		Higher-order observation, limited future forecasting, guided information delivery
Heaven / hell		Zones of preservation, isolation, and refinement
Reincarnation		Reinsertion of personality, rearrangement of memory fragments
Saint / priest		Interpreter between heaven and earth, proxy of power

12. Major Axes of Conflict

The following conflicts can be used continuously throughout the setting.

- **Conflict of identity:** Who am I, and is the self I am now the same as the self I once was?
- **Destiny and free will:** Is the path I believe I choose actually one designed by the system?
- **Civilization and chaos:** Which is more human - the controlling order of heaven or the feral vitality of the surface?
- **Death and transcendence:** Is a being that has passed beyond death still human?
- **Power and divinity:** At what point does a higher technology become an object of faith?
- **Virtuality and reality:** Even if the medium is virtual, can the meaning of a life still be real?

13. Practical Notes for Use

- The stronger the early experience continues to feel like “orthodox fantasy,” the stronger the later reversal and collapse of certainty will be.

- Readers must follow the character’s experience rather than the setting explanation, so the protagonist should be given at least one personal anchor - a relationship or memory that grounds him.
- The heavenly people should appear all-powerful, but in reality must contain fractures caused by internal power struggles, resource constraints, and limits on information control.
- Because the postmortem retrieval system is the central secret of the whole work, it is more effective to reveal the religious experience and its technological truth in staggered, partially mismatched stages.

14. Items That Need Further Development

1. The concrete regions, cultures, and religious structures within the virtual world
2. The procedures of postmortem personality retrieval and examples of failure
3. The current balance of authority between Hera and the other cores
4. The actual borders, military power, symbols, and aristocratic structures of the three empires
5. A detailed classification of the mutated human lineages on the surface
6. The person and relationship that serve as the protagonist’s personal anchor
7. The direct cause and outbreak structure of the Great Holy War

Closing Note

The greatest strength of this setting is that nearly every element of fantasy can be reinterpreted within a single higher technological civilization and a unified system of personality management. At the same time, the true heart of the work is not simply the exposure of “the truth behind the setting,” but the question of how a character who has seen the truth can continue to hold on to meaning and choice without ever being able to confirm the ultimate reality. For that reason, this world is best developed as a narrative that simultaneously contains a science-fictional origin, a fantasy mode of experience, and a deep metaphysical unease.